



Premium Truly Wireless Earphones

(Over ₹10K)

Pure sonic immersiveness sans tethers

2022 has been a fantastic year for premium truly wireless (TWS) earphones. While it's true that mid-range TWS have quickly been catching up, the premium ones often have an undeniable edge in terms of sonic performance. Whether this is achieved by multi-driver technologies, robust ANC, or just the premium materials, premium TWS earbuds certainly still have an edge over their mid-range counterparts. This year, we had multiple launches in this category in India from various companies. All with their own strengths and weaknesses, we put these devices to test and were left with one standing tall as the winner.

Winner: Samsung Galaxy Buds2 Pro

Equipped with 24-bit Hi-Fi audio support and coaxial dual drivers, the Samsung Galaxy Buds2 Pro have fantastic sonic fidelity. Due to the dual-driver setup, you get detailed audio reproduction with instruments and vocals shining in their own space in the mix. The bass response is balanced, the mids sound exquisitely detailed, and the highs are quite well-produced resulting in a harmonious sound signature. The Active Noise Cancellation is also impressive enough, especially in the low-end. Overall, the Samsung Galaxy Buds2 Pro dominates the 2022 TWS segment when it comes to sonic purity.



Samsung Galaxy Buds2 Pro

Price: Starting at ₹17,999

Runner-up: Sony WF-1000XM4

The Sony WF-1000X series earphones are universally lauded for a reason – class-leading ANC. While the Samsung Galaxy Buds2 Pro beat out the Sony WF-1000XM4 due to pure sound quality, the WF-1000XM4 are still, irrefutably, the best Noise Cancelling TWS of 2022. These earphones convincingly cancel out most ambient sounds across the frequencies. They're no slouch when it comes to sound quality either. While the sound isn't as balanced as the Samsung, the mids are produced with almost no error. But the bass bias is higher here though which can cloud some of the details in the mids. Where Sony wins again apart from ANC is battery life – you get 24 hours of total listening time with ANC turned on, which is considerably better than the Samsung Galaxy Buds2 Pro.

2nd Runner-up: AirPods Pro (2nd generation)

If you're an iPhone user, the AirPods

Pro (2nd generation) is an excellent choice. The earbuds come with improved Active Noise Cancellation and sound quality. It has a warm sound signature that sounds great with most popular genres of music, however, there's a noticeable bump in low-bass emphasis that can cause some tracks to sound boomy. That aside, the AirPods Pro also comes with Spatial Audio with head tracking that creates an incredibly immersive experience when you listen to supported media.

Best Buy: OPPO Enco X2

At the competitive price of ₹10,999, the OPPO Enco X2 comes with coaxial dual drivers comprising of a dynamic driver and a planar tweeter. Planar tweeters are usually found on premium headphones, but OPPO has democratised this technology. It results in a pretty balanced sound signature with slight bass bias but oodles of detail and character.

The bass response is fast-attacking and has a very short decay. Add to this an array of premium features and you've got yourself a value-for-money TWS that's comfortably playing in the big leagues.

– Dhriti Datta /

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Sony WF-1000XM4
Price: ₹19,990



AirPods Pro (2nd gen.)
Price: ₹26,900

DIGIT BEST BUY WINNER-2022



OPPO Enco X2
Price: ₹10,999